FROM IDEA TO PRODUCT

An iterative product case study in consumer social design, incentive economics, monetisation, growth strategy and problem-solving

Meme & Creator Platform

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Project status	**Independent product concept / research case study**
Primary focus	Product strategy • business modelling • user incentives • growth
Core method	Research → model → challenge assumptions → redesign → stress-test
Final direction	Free-to-enter social platform with paid creation beyond a daily allowance, optional creator verification, controlled reward pools and advertising

Purpose: to demonstrate how I approach an ambiguous product problem, use quantitative reasoning to challenge an attractive idea, and iteratively turn it into a more controlled business model.

1. Executive Summary

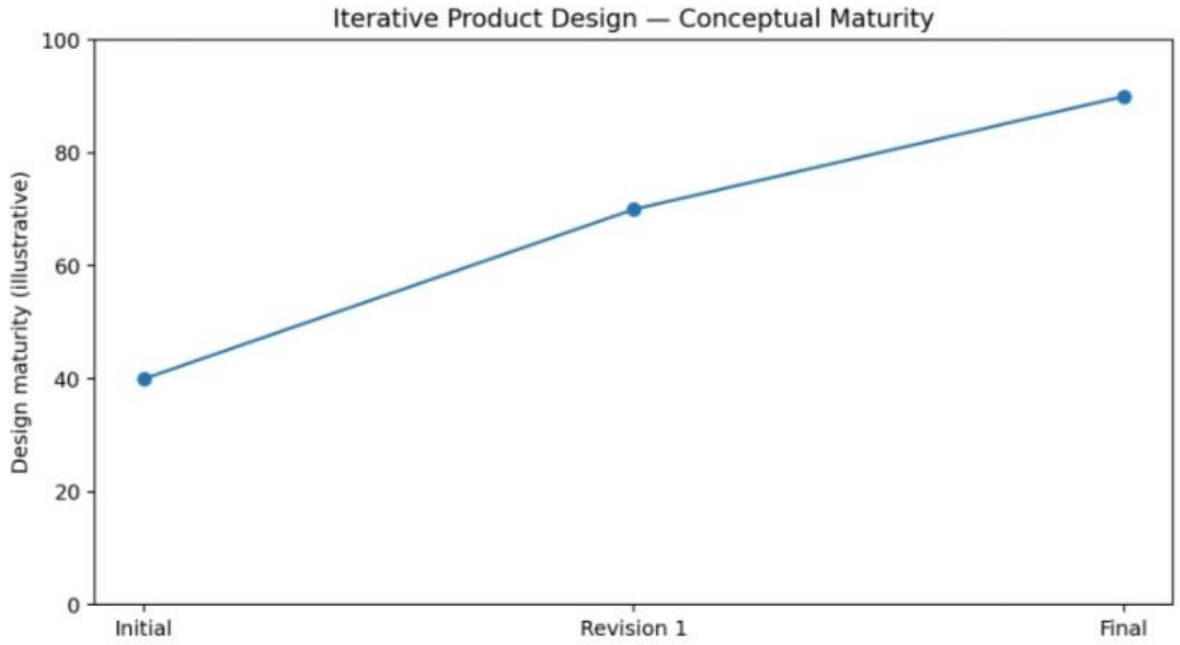
The project began with a simple question: could a Nigerian social platform built around memes and short-form video create an entertaining community while also giving active users a pathway to earn small amounts of money? I did not treat the first idea as the final product. I modelled the incentives, identified where the economics could become dangerous, removed or redesigned features that created uncontrolled liabilities, and eventually arrived at a more disciplined model.

The final concept combines an in-app meme/video creation experience, social interaction, creator verification, controlled monthly reward pools, advertising, and a two-tier badge system. A key design decision was separating participation from reward eligibility: users can still use the platform without paying, while a White Badge can be used as a paid gateway to competitive rewards and other premium participation benefits.

The most important lesson was not the final revenue number. It was the process: a product can look attractive from the user's perspective and still be structurally unsustainable. I learned to model both sides of the marketplace — what users receive and what the company must fund — before treating a feature as viable.

What I demonstrated

Area	Evidence of work
Product thinking	Defined core experience, user roles, creator flows, verification and reward mechanics.
Quantitative reasoning	Modelled revenue, rewards, operating costs, user growth and alternative scenarios.
Critical thinking	Rejected the first reward structure after identifying excessive liability.
Business analysis	Connected user behaviour, pricing, monetisation and operating costs.
Growth strategy	Designed a creator-first launch model using campuses, micro-influencers, referrals and competitions.
Iteration	Repeatedly changed the product when the economics or incentives did not make sense



The maturity chart is conceptual and illustrates the iteration path rather than a measured KPI.

2. Product Evolution: From Attractive Idea to Controlled Model

Stage 1: The original concept

The first version centred on a Nigerian meme/social platform with built-in written meme and short-video creation. The vision included accounts, creator profiles, rankings, verification, rewards and monetisation. A strong social objective was also present: create an entertaining space where people could spend time positively and where active users could earn pocket money.

The initial monetisation/reward concept included roughly ₦100 for each meme created, ₦3 per video view, ₦2.50 per comment subject to a monthly cap, monthly prizes for top users, a ₦150/day viewing subscription, and paid verification. It was intentionally generous to users but that generosity exposed the central economic problem.

Stage 2: Stress-testing the incentives

The model was examined from the company's side. Paying users for every unit of activity creates a liability that grows directly with usage. That is dangerous for a social platform because successful growth can increase costs faster than revenue. The solution was not to abandon rewards; it was to bound and control the reward liability.

Stage 3: Revision of the reward architecture

The daily viewing subscription was removed. Meme creation moved to ₦7 after a free daily allowance, video verification/watermarking was set at ₦50, and reward pools were changed to fixed monthly amounts: ₦6m for the top 100 commenters and ₦3m for the top 100 viewers. Verified creators could earn ₦0.05 per qualified view. Blue verification remained at ₦20,000 for six months or ₦38,800 annually.

Stage 4: Final stronger version

The strongest version added a free seven-meme daily allowance and introduced a White Badge at ₦2,000/month or ₦23,100/year. The White Badge became the gateway for participation in the competitive commenter/viewer reward pools. This preserved a free user funnel while creating a recurring monetisation layer among users who want access to the earning/competitive ecosystem.

Version	Core change	Reason
Initial	High per-action rewards + daily viewing subscription	Strong user attraction, but potentially uncontrolled cost.
Revision 1	Remove daily subscription; lower/structure rewards	Reduce recurring liability and improve predictability.
Revision 2	Fixed ₦6m + ₦3m reward pools; ₦7/meme; ₦50/video	Make reward expenditure controllable.
Final	7 free memes/day + White Badge + existing Blue Badge	Keep free acquisition while monetising premium/reward participation

3. Final Product Architecture

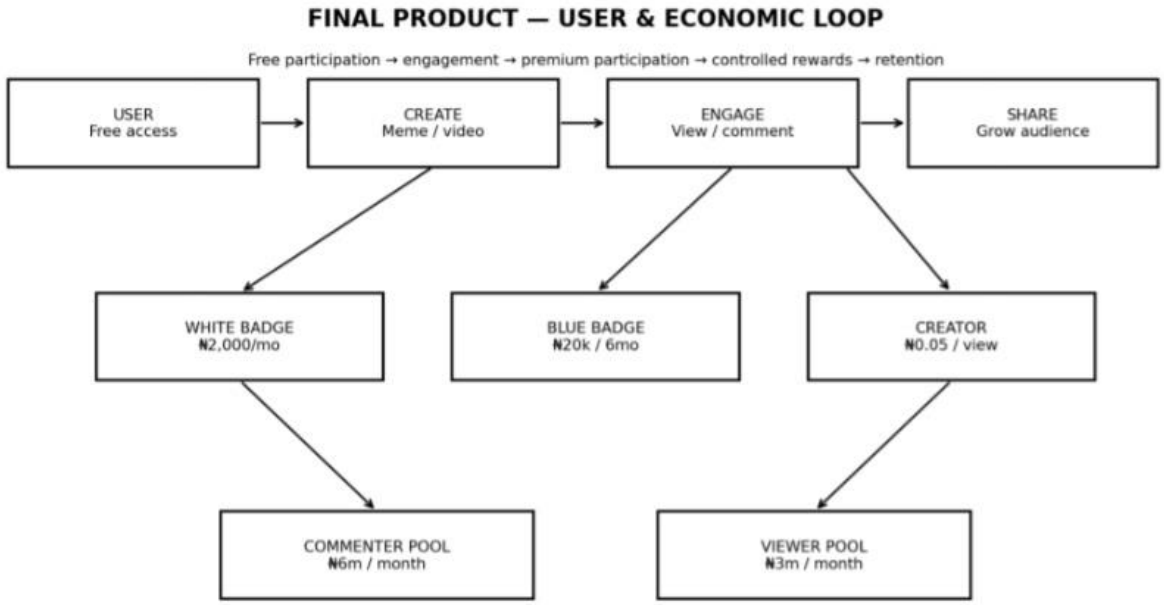
Core user experience

Component	Final direction
Creation	Built-in written meme and short-form video creation.
Free access	Users can participate without paying; first 7 memes each day are free.
Paid creation	₦7 per meme after the daily free allowance.
Video	₦50 verification/watermarking fee for video content.
White Badge	₦2,000/month or ₦23,100/year; unlocks eligibility for the competitive reward ecosystem.
Blue Badge	₦20,000/6 months or ₦38,800/year; premium verification and increased visibility/creator positioning.
Commenter rewards	Top 100 share ₦6m/month.
Viewer rewards	Top 100 share ₦3m/month.
Creator rewards	Verified creators receive ₦0.05 per qualified view.
Advertising	Introduced as a scalable monetisation layer as audience grows.

Why the final architecture is stronger

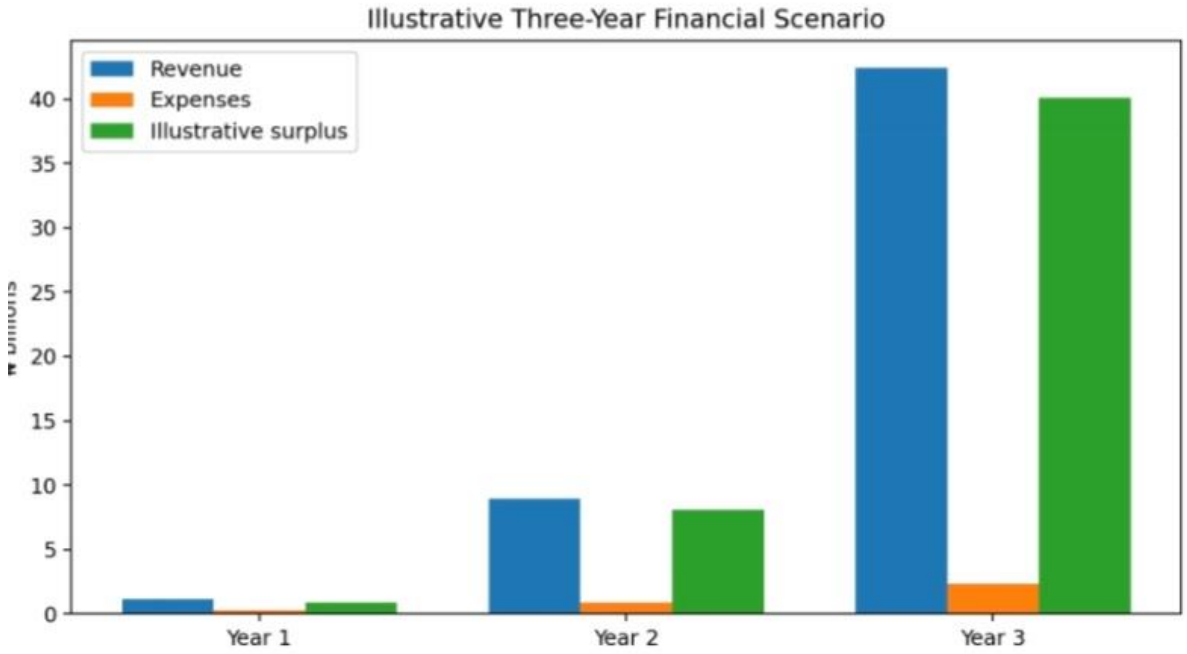
The model creates several distinct economic layers instead of relying on one revenue stream. Free creation reduces the barrier to acquisition. Paid creation monetises heavy creators. White Badge creates recurring subscription revenue from users who want access to the reward ecosystem. Blue Badge creates a higher-value creator/verification product. Advertising can monetise the broader audience. Meanwhile, the major monthly reward pools are fixed rather than automatically increasing with every comment or view.

Design principle: rewards should drive behaviour without becoming an unlimited financial promise.



4. Financial Modelling & Scenario Analysis

The financial model was used as a decision-making tool rather than as a claim that the business would necessarily achieve these numbers. The scenario assumed approximately 500,000 active users in Year 1, 2million in Year 2 and 7 million in Year 3, with revenue from meme creation,



video verification, White/Blue Badges and advertising.

Illustrative scenario: revenue of approximately ₦1.166bn / ₦8.953bn / ₦42.41bn across Years 1–3. An efficiency scenario reduced the previously modelled non-reward operating-cost base to 15% of the original estimate (an 85% reduction), producing illustrative operating surpluses of about ₦850.5m / ₦8.09bn / ₦40.10bn. These figures are scenario outputs, not forecasts.

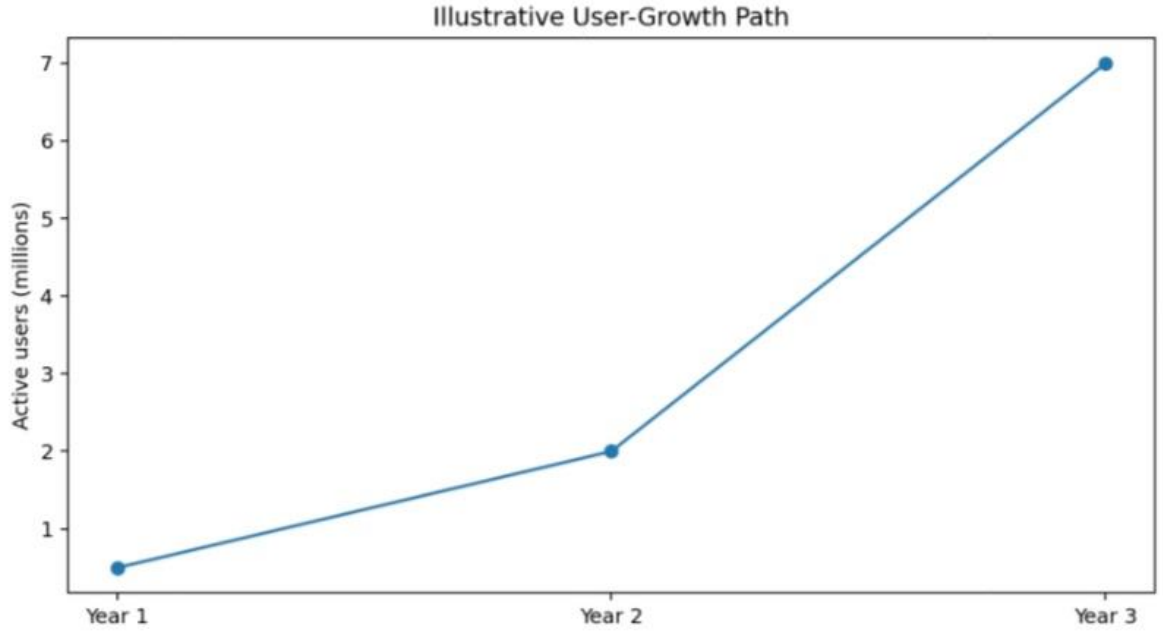
Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Illustrative active users	500k	2.0m	7.0m
Revenue	₦1.166bn	₦8.953bn	₦42.41bn
Efficiency-scenario expenses	₦315.5m	₦863m	₦2.308bn
Illustrative surplus	₦850.5m	₦8.09bn	₦40.10bn

Critical interpretation: the 85% operating-cost reduction is an aggressive efficiency assumption. I would not present it to an investor as a guaranteed outcome. It's value in the exercise was showing how sensitive the model is to infrastructure, staffing, security, marketing

and administrative efficiency. A real launch would require bottom-up testing of cloud costs, moderation, payment fees, acquisition costs, fraud, support and reward abuse before committing capital.

5. Launch & Growth Strategy

The product cannot launch successfully as an empty social network. The growth problem was therefore treated as a marketplace/community-seeding problem: build the supply of interesting content before asking a large audience to arrive.



The long-term illustrative scenario used in the financial model is 500k active users in Year 1, 2m in Year 2 and 7m in Year 3. The first-year launch strategy focused on building the first 100,000 users rather than assuming viral growth.

First 100,000 users: community-first approach

Phase	Objective	Execution
Pre-launch	Seed content	Recruit founding meme creators, skit creators, micro-influencers and campus ambassadors.
Closed beta	Validate product	Target first ~5,000 users; test creation, feeds, sharing, ranking and retention.
Expansion	Reach ~50k	Campus communities, creator challenges, micro-influencers, WhatsApp/referral loops, X and Tiktok advertisements
Scale	Reach 100k+	Daily competitions, creator rankings, ambassador programme and repeatable referral mechanics plus other ads platforms

Important product-growth decision: external sharing should not be completely blocked. Instead, shared content can carry creator attribution and a platform watermark. This converts off-platform distribution into acquisition rather than treating it only as leakage.

6. What This Project Says About How I Work

The value of this project is less about the meme category and more about the method I used to develop it.

Behaviour	How it appeared in the project
I challenge my own ideas	I did not preserve the original reward model simply because it sounded attractive to users
I use numbers to test intuition	Revenue, reward liability, user growth and operating costs were modelled before treating the concept as viable.
I break ambiguous problems into components	Creation, engagement, verification, rewards, advertising, acquisition and operating costs were analysed separately.
I iterate rather than defend a first draft	The model went through multiple revisions before reaching the final structure.
I think about incentives	The product was designed around the behaviour each pricing/reward mechanism should encourage.
I think about growth before launch	The launch plan focused on creator supply and community density rather than simply buying downloads.
I use AI and analytical tools as accelerators	Research, scenario exploration, modelling and refinement were supported by AI and analytical workflows

7. What I Would Test Before Building

The next stage would not be immediately spending heavily on development. I would test the assumptions with real users and small experiments: willingness to pay for the badges, creator retention, content creation frequency, reward-seeking behaviour, referral conversion, advertising economics, fraud/abuse patterns and actual infrastructure cost per active user. The product should earn the right to scale.

“An idea is not the product, and a spreadsheet is not proof” the purpose of the analysis is to identify what needs to be tested next.

8. Why I Am Sharing This as a Product Case Study

I am not presenting this project as a request for a company to build a meme app for me. I am presenting it as evidence of how I approach product and business problems independently.

I started with an ambiguous consumer problem, created a product hypothesis, designed an incentive system, modelled the economics, identified a structural weakness, redesigned the model, and developed a launch strategy. That process is the part of the work I want to carry into an early-stage team.